

155 Economic Trends Research Individual

(formerly 155 Economic Research Individual)

SECONDARY EVENT ONLY

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will apply economic principles to analyze global and domestic trends, conduct research using credible sources, and present evidence-based solutions in both a paper and a presentation. Contestants must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. Entries that do not follow the provided topic or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

The Gig Economy and Income Stability. How has the rise of gig work (Uber, DoorDash, freelance platforms) reshaped traditional employment models, and what are the long-term economic implications for workers who forgo traditional benefits, pensions, and job security in favor of flexible, independent income streams?

Considerations

- Wage volatility and income unpredictability for gig workers
- Lack of employer-sponsored benefits (health insurance, retirement, paid leave)
- Tax implications and financial planning challenges for independent contractors
- Labor market shifts and the decline of traditional full-time employment
- Circular flow implications

Contestant Must Supply

- Students may use one single-sided laptop, notebook, or tablet for their presentation. Projection equipment and external displays will not be provided or permitted.

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the contestant within the time allotted
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, contestants may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges
- Business Professionals of America assumes no responsibility for hardware/software provided by the contestant
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes setup time, no more than seven (7) minutes presentation time, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Naming Convention	National Deadline
The following documents are saved in one combined PDF: 1. Research Paper 2. Works Cited 3. BPA Release Form(s) 4. AI Usage and Documentation Form	ETRI-ContestantID.pdf	April 1, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Apply foundational economic concepts to analyze and interpret global and domestic economic trends
2. Conduct rigorous economic research using credible sources and communicate findings clearly and professionally through oral presentations and written reports
3. Analyze workplace economic factors such as productivity, labor markets, and technological change to inform organizational strategy and decision-making
4. Compare and contrast global economic systems, evaluating their effectiveness in addressing contemporary economic challenges
5. Evaluate strategies for promoting sustainable economic growth and apply modern metrics to measure economic performance
6. Utilize diverse research methodologies and digital resources to gather, analyze, and interpret economic data, ensuring ethical standards and data integrity
7. Critically analyze economic issues using quantitative and qualitative methods and propose evidence-based solutions aligned with industry trends

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Follow the Report format located in the *Style & Reference Manual*. (Note: no Title Page is required.) Header information on the first page of the report should be as follows: Contestant ID Number (Sender's ID Number - XXXXXXXX), Harvey Rosen (Recipient's Name), Financial Services Department (Recipient's Department), and Current Date
- Document length is limited to seven double-spaced, single-sided, numbered pages with one-inch margins. The Works Cited page(s) is not included in this limit, but graphs, tables, and charts are. Judges will not read beyond the seven (7) allowed pages
- Each research paper must reflect the contestant's own research, writing, and original thinking. In-text citations are required throughout the paper

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- This is a pre-submitted event. Regional and state conferences have specific deadlines prior to the national deadline. Please consult the regional or state conference administrator for those deadlines. For the National Leadership Conference, submit the URL to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on April 1, 2027. No changes can be made to the project after the date of submission.
- Contestant ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered contestants and/or those missing Contestant ID cannot be accepted.
- The contestant is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including oneself, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including oneself, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for copyright and fair use. Participants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

155 Economic Trends Research Individual

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Contestant submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing their Research Paper and Works Cited in the correct format according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s) and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-20 points	Above Expectations 21-30	Points Awarded
Comprehension of Topic	Shows limited understanding, with inaccuracies and shallow explanations. Ideas are unclear and poorly connected.	Demonstrates clear understanding with accurate explanations and relevant examples, with logical connections.	Exhibits deep understanding, explaining complex ideas clearly with insightful examples and thorough coverage.	/30
Organization and Expansion of Ideas	The argument lacks structure, with weak transitions and underdeveloped ideas.	The argument is logical and coherent, with clear transitions and well-developed points.	The argument is well-organized, with smooth transitions and thoroughly expanded points, demonstrating clear reasoning.	/30
Introduction/Summary	The introduction and summary lack clarity, with underdeveloped arguments and insufficient evidence.	The introduction and summary present a logical argument, with appropriate evidence supporting conclusions.	The introduction and summary are compelling, with strong evidence and a concise, impactful summary.	/30
Creativity	The response lacks creativity, using generic ideas and limited resources.	The response is creative, offering an original perspective with diverse resources supporting the ideas.	The response is highly original and inventive, with well-integrated resources adding depth and creativity.	/30
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/30
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/160

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Contestant rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Contestant occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Contestant maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, and the speaker's structure is unclear. Transitions between points are awkward or missing, making it difficult to follow the overall flow.	Presentation has some structural gaps, and the speaker's organization is inconsistent. Transitions between points are present but choppy, affecting the clarity of the message.	Presentation flows logically, with a clear and well-integrated structure. The speaker transitions smoothly between points, enhancing the overall coherence and impact.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-30 points	Above Expectations 31-50 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/50
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than seven (7) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT SEVEN (7) MINUTES